

BOOKPOOL USER GUIDE

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Overview

BookPool is a virtual library web application where users can share, borrow, and discuss books. This guide walks through the key features of the site and how to test them.

Site URL: <http://localhost:5173>

Admin credentials: AdminUser1@gmail.com / AdminUser1 (email:password)

Example user credentials: user7@example.com / 12345

How to get run site

1. Pull project from github, branch should be development
2. Have docker open
3. In root branch of project, run docker compose up --build
4. Site should boot up and be available at <http://localhost:5173>

Walkthrough:

When the user first gets on the website, they can access the list of books from a guest view, they cannot borrow or view threads and can only look at their details. The guest user can also search in the bar or by categories.

Registration

1. Press the Register button on the top right or go to <http://localhost:5173/register>
2. Fill out all the fields, it is optional to upload a profile image.
3. If you are missing a field, ie password, city, it will return a warning to fill it in.
 - a. User's password must be 5 characters or more and include a number
 - b. The confirmed password must be the same as the first typed password.
4. Click Submit & Login and you will automatically be logged in and redirected to your profile.

Login

1. If you decide to log out, you can log back in by entering your email and password
2. Click submit & login to reenter your profile page.

Browsing & Searching Books

1. Navigate to <http://localhost:5173/home>
2. Books are displayed in a 3-column grid

3. Use the search bar to search by title or description and press Search
4. Use the category dropdown to filter by genre, books filter automatically without pressing Search
5. Use the Sort dropdown to sort by Newest, Hottest (most thread posts), or Available First (not borrowed)
6. Click Clear to reset all filters

Viewing a Book and Borrowing

1. Click on any book card to open the book details
2. The modal shows the title, category, description, and borrow status
3. If the book is available, click "Borrow Book" to borrow it
4. If the book is already borrowed, click Join Queue to join a queue for when it becomes available
5. Once in the queue, the button changes to Leave Queue, if the book is returned, A pop up will say the book is reserved for 24 hours for you to borrow.
6. Press escape or click outside the modal to close it

Return a Book

1. Navigate to your profile at the top right or <http://localhost:5173/profile>
2. Under borrowed books, find the book your borrowed
3. Click "Return Book"
4. The book is returned and the next person in queue can borrow it.

Adding a Book

1. Navigate to <http://localhost:5173/add-book> (must be logged in)
2. Fill in the book's details and optionally add a cover image
3. Click Add Book, an alert will pop up and redirect you Home

Discussion Threads

1. Open any book modal and click View Threads
2. You are taken to the discussion page for that book
3. The breadcrumb at the top shows: Home > Book Title > Discussion
4. Click the book title in the breadcrumb to return to Home with the modal already open
5. Type a reply in the text area and click Post - a green success alert appears
6. Each post shows the user's profile picture, username, and timestamp
7. Click Hide on any post to collapse it without reloading; click Show to expand it again
8. Users can delete their own posts using the trash icon on the right of each post

User Profile

1. Navigate to <http://localhost:5173/profile>
2. Your profile displays your username, email, city, profile picture, and About Me section
3. Click Upload Image to update your profile picture
4. Click Edit Profile to update your username, email, city, password, or About Me
5. The profile also shows:

- Books you have listed for borrowing
- Books you currently have borrowed
- Your active thread posts (click any to go to that thread)

Admin Features

Admin dashboard:

- Click the Dashboard tag on the profile page to go to the admin dashboard
- The dashboard shows site usage charts including total users, books, threads, and activity over time

Search users:

- On the profile page, scroll to the Search Users section
- Search by username to find and delete users
- You can also just press the Search button to show all users.

Delete any post:

- As admin, the trash icon delete button appears on every thread post, not just your own

Edit or delete any book:

- As admin, the Edit Book button appears in every book modal

Unique Features:

- **Borrowing queue** - users join a waiting list for borrowed books and receive a 24-hour reservation window when the book becomes available
- **Async polling** - the home page and threads page refresh automatically every 5 seconds so changes made by other users appear without a page refresh
- **Breadcrumb navigation** - clicking the book title in the thread breadcrumb reopens the book modal on the home page
- **Collapsible threads** - posts can be hidden and shown without reloading the page
- **Inline alerts** - success and error messages appear directly on the page without pop-ups
- **Hot sorting** - books can be sorted by number of thread posts to find the most discussed books
- **Auto category filter** - selecting a category instantly filters books without needing to press Search
- **Admin Dashboard** - seeing metrics regarding the website